

THE CAMBRIDGE HARKENER

CELEBRATING THE HERITAGE OF CAMBRIDGE, VERMONT

Vol. II, No. 3

Fall 2003

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Ron Bechard, Diancy Boyden,

Julie Brown, Ronnie Little,

Bill Sander, Jane Shaw, Linda Ward

Advisory Board Members: Harold Putnam, Wendell Wells

Cambridge Historical Society Sign

As a guild member of the Historical Society of Early American Decoration, I am always interested in painted decorations.

I was inspired to do the sign after a sign made in 1749. I attended a series of lectures at the Hood Museum in Hanover, NH and went to the exhibit of 26 historical signs that had been restored by the Connecticut Historical Society. I purchased the book that was written by the restoration people and proceeded to design a sign for us, with permission of the Board and a budget of \$200. The sign cost was under \$100 as all involved donated their time and materials to make it a reality.

My first quest was to find someone to cut the sign board and make the turnings. I asked Bob Fletcher of

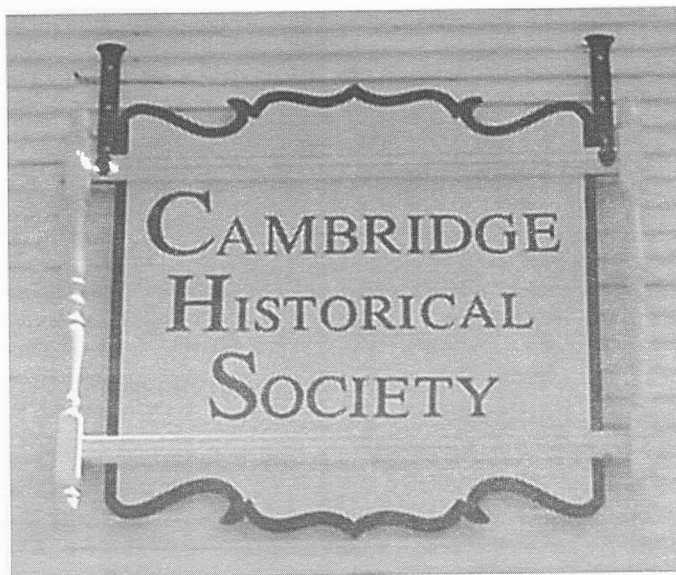
Robert Fletcher Furniture Design if he would help me

and the answer was a resounding "yes". He bought the sign board and proceeded to make the turnings. After that was done, I painted it with several coats of sign maker's paint and then proceeded to do the lettering. As the paint was drying, I asked another one of our members, Peter Krusch, to make the metal work that we needed to keep the sign up. He also willingly obliged and forged the iron work and put it on the sign for me.

Next, it needed to be put up. Marc Mallett and Jim Kinney put the sign on the building for all to see, just in time for the 4th of July festivities.

Thank you to everyone who helped make this a reality.

—Martha Kinney



In this issue

Cambridge Historical Society Sign

Coming Events

Wish List

May 17—Stafford

New Display Cases

June 20-21—History Expo

August 17-18—Open House

July 4th—Parade

June 6th—Fundraiser at the Sanders

Web Site Information

Coming Events

November 12

7:00 pm

Monthly Meeting

The Flood of '27

A Slide Show by Stub Wells

Drawing for the Turkey Raffle
(see below)

December 10

7:00 pm

Monthly Meeting

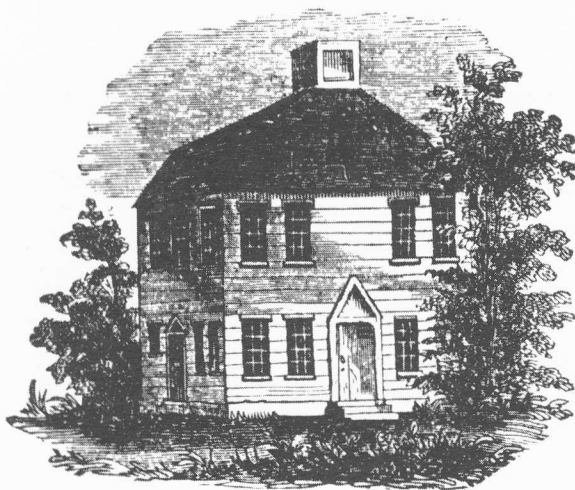
Old time dessert potluck and gift exchange
Bring your favorite holiday dessert and a wrapped
gift (nothing more than \$5 please) for a unique
holiday experience.

Drawing for the Theorem Raffle
(see below)

Raffles

Beginning at the Old Farm Days in October, raffle
tickets will be available for 2 items

- [1] Linda Ward has once again agreed to
donate a turkey for Thanksgiving. The
drawing will be held at the November
meeting.
- [2] Martha Kinney is donating a set of Theo-
rems for auction. Only 500 tickets will be
sold. The drawing will be at our Decem-
ber meeting.

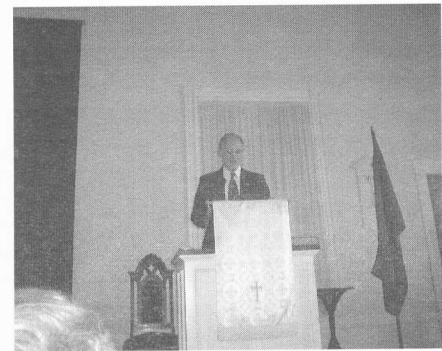


Wish List

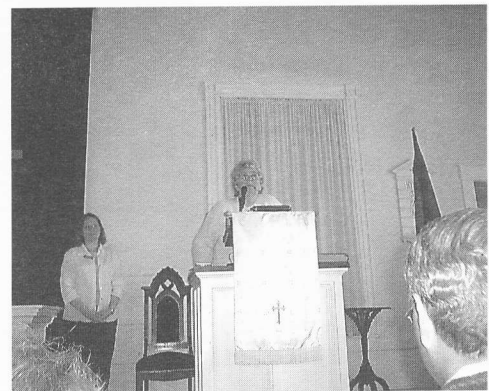
This could be endless, but right now:

Desk
Bookcases
File Cabinets
Display Cases
Storage Cabinets

May 17—Meeting of Local Historical Societies, Stafford



The Governor addressed the members....



...and Roberta accepted our



AWARD!

New Display Cases

We've started to collect cases in which to display the acquisitions we are steadily collecting. We are very lucky to have generous as well as talented members. This display case, one of three, was salvaged by Martha Kinney from the Grafton Nature Center and refinished by Jim Kinney. The bottom storage/support unit was built by Hugh List. The following is a short description of the construction process.



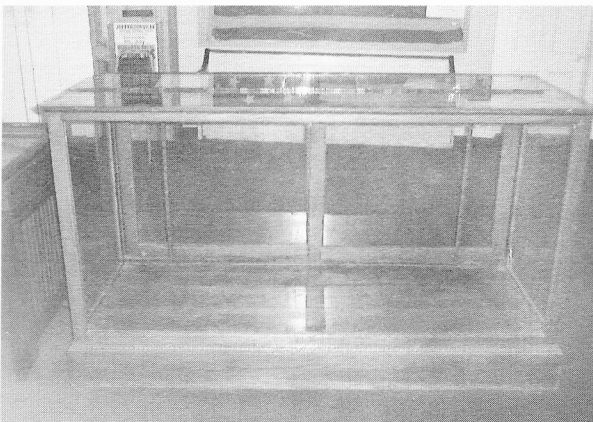
The design was selected by the CHS Board from three renderings I made. The wainscoting for the panel inserts was chosen because it came closest to that used in the building.

There were no unusual construction methods used. Stile and rail with panel inserts has been used for several hundred years although the assembly was done using a more modern joinery technique called biscuit joints.

I agonized over the color for several weeks. I'd originally thought I wanted to try to match the color of the displays and made about thirty tests on small pieces of pine as attempts. I even solicited help from Minwax for a formula of mixed stains, sending them a picture of the displays so they could see the color, but wisely, they deferred. Since I never got close enough to the original color, I finally colored them as dark as possible to make them fade into the background.

Clark Dodge had one requirement: that there be a shelf inside to accommodate storage. Clark also suggested that I shouldn't plan on attaching the support cabinets to the displays, so the top extensions and rails to enclose the displays were made using the displays as models. Clark helped me transport the displays over to my garage so that I could fit them exactly. The consequence is that each cabinet is custom fitted to its display. The casters were also his suggestion.

—Hugh List



The display case to the left was found by Jim Kinney. Recognizing its use to the Society, he purchased it for us. The cost was born my Jim & Martha Kinney and Linda Ward.

po Success

reenactments, food—the Vermont
 orical societies' exhibits but the
 d the Cambridge Historical Society
 o display. What attracts more
 or photo of a skeleton? Not much!
 e booth because of the skeletal
 would stop upon noticing the
 reading the story of John Wood and
 design used plenty of photos and
 could choose to enter the booth and
 pause in the aisle, skim the words,
 n one passerby chose to enter and
 kim").

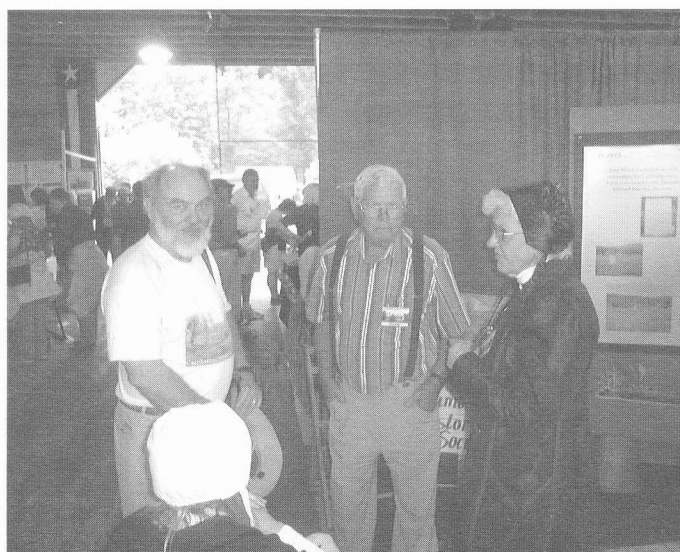
hile I was on booth duty: Why did
 and reburied? As a newcomer to the
 members had crib sheets available so I
 n about the Tatro sand pit.
 ession of me: How does that hat
 t doesn't" had to be my answer. I
 igned location to make a
 carry in the parade. People making
 person who was creating them right
 , put it on, and promptly forgot I was

ed on an interesting story, a
 ted and talented volunteers every
 lementing to cleaning up. In this
 I prove a hard act to follow, but I
 y more interesting stories to tell and
 ntinue to use their ingenuity and
 great display next year and the year

arcia Gustafson (the one with the hat)



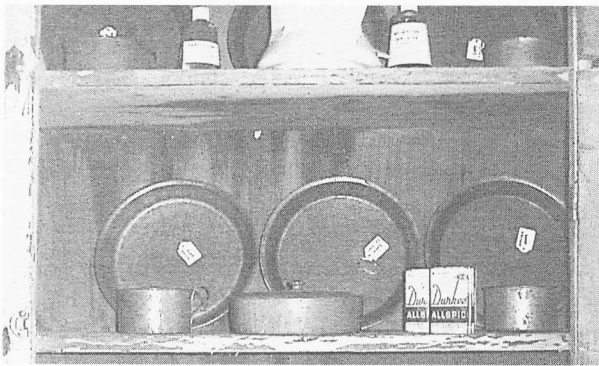
June Dodge in 19th Century garb,
 helped everyone get into the spirit of the Expo



Bill McKone was one of several CHS members to drop by

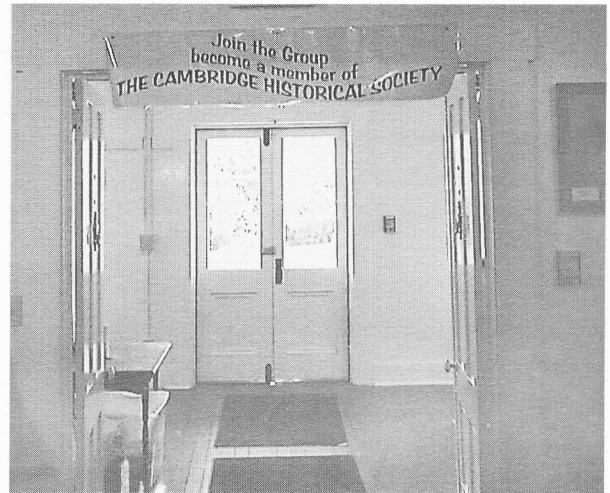
August 16th & 17th—Open House

The Cambridge Historical Society held an Open House on August 16 & 17. On exhibit were old photos, day journals and ledgers of stores in the town of Cambridge. Some recorded the names of the towns' earliest settlers. Some ledgers had been stored in the basement of the Town Clerk's Office. The ledgers dated back as far as 1829. Most were kept by members of the Griswold family. Willard Griswold was Town Clerk in Cambridge for 50 years.



Meeting House (now the Post Office) where they sold and repaired autos. Members of the Pope family also had an Undertaking business last operated by the late Wesley Pope.

The Society has volumes of books containing *Cambridge Transcripts* printed in



There were also ledgers purchased by the Dodges at the Pope auction with accounts of the different ventures of the Pope family. Their businesses included a Store in what is now Hanleys, a Blacksmith Shop, a Garage (between Smugglers' Notch Inn and the Town



Cambridge Village in the late 1800s.

We plan to have another exhibit as there were many people who said they would like to return and do more research. At the next exhibit we hope to have more artifacts available.

We want to thank all who helped to make this exhibit a success.

—Clark Dodge

July 4th Parade

Several Cambridge Historical Society members collaborated on our entry for the July 4th Parade this year. Our work paid off — we won the trophy for Best In Theme! Marc Mallet came up with the idea of using Jan and Bill Sander's 1954 Dodge Fire Truck for our float. At 8:00 am on the morning of July 4th, Julie Brown, Geana Little, Martha Kinney, Ann Mallett and Marcia Gustafson gathered with Jan and Bill in front of their home on Maple Street to decorate the truck. Marcia made a poster "Let Freedom Ring", Martha brought the Historical Society banner, Jan brought flags, handbells, duct tape, scissors and bags of candy. The group set to work. In no time at all, our creation was complete!

David Sander showed up to drive the truck with the able assistance of his 2 year old son, Will Sander. Julie, Geana, Martha and Ann got their handbells, Marcia got the candy and they all climbed aboard. Off to the parade they went. The siren wailed, the bells rang and the candy flew!

—Jan Sander



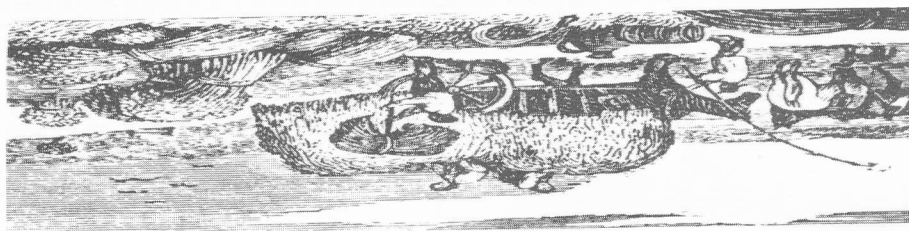
June 6—Fundraiser at Jan & Bill Sanders

On Friday June 6, the Cambridge Historical Society held a fundraiser at Jan and Bill Sander's garage in South Cambridge for the New England MG T Register. The Vermont Chapter of the Register was hosting a meet in Stowe and part of the activities included a ride through the Notch to the Sander's garage where lunch, provided by the host hotel, was eaten. The Society sold desserts and beverages to compliment the lunch. Bill McKone gave an interesting talk about covered bridges, after which there was a tour of several bridges in Lamoille County. Linda Ward gave carriage rides for donations which went to support the Collections Committee.

The MG people liked our desserts better than the hotel fare. Linda was quite the hit with her beautiful carriage and her handsome pair of horses. Everyone who attended had a delightful time and really enjoyed the wonderful hospitality of the Cambridge Historical Society.

—Jan Sander

Cambridge Historical Society
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The site includes cemetery archives, a list of the newsletters and their contents, a photo archive, links to other web sites which may be of interest to our members and a calendar of events.
Although I try to keep the site as up-to-date as possible, I have been lax in the past. If anyone has something they would like posted on the web site please let me know, either by e-mail (gmlittle@sover.net) or by phone (644-5675).
I know the site has been accessed by out-of-staters, since I get messages from them both thanking us for the information we have posted and asking for more information or contacts. Many people whose ancestors left for warmer climates years ago are now interested in their roots. I like to think that we have helped them in a small way.

www.sover.net/~gmlittle

The Society has a web site